STAAR Bootcamp: championship-week

🏈 STAAR Athletes: Championship Week — Quick-Start Overview

Welcome, Coach!

You've just downloaded **Championship Week** — a sports-themed STAAR prep week that frames the entire test as the Big Game. Your students are athletes in training, you're the head coach, and STAAR day is game day. This week is their pre-season training camp.

📦 What's in This Package

File	What It Is
LESSON-PLANS.md	5-day plan framed as a tournament bracket leading to game day
ACTIVITIES.md	12 themed activities including practice drills, halftime show, and review games
DECORATIONS.md	Stadium tunnel hallway, locker room doors, scoreboard, and classroom setup
STUDENT-MATERIALS.md	Playbooks, MVP awards, trading cards, jerseys, certificates
PARENT-LETTER.md	Ready-to-send family communication

🏆 The Theme at a Glance

- **Setting:** Championship tournament / Training facility
- **Students are:** Athletes preparing for the big game

- **Teacher is:** Head Coach
- **Each day is:** A round in the tournament (Quarterfinals → Semifinals → etc.)
- **Completing work earns:** MVP Awards & advancement on the bracket
- **The week builds to:** Game Day (STAAR test day)
- **Hallway becomes:** Stadium tunnel entrance
- **Classroom becomes:** Team locker room / training facility

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📅 Week Overview

Day	Round	Focus
Monday	**Quarterfinals: Draft Day**	Foundation skills, team building, setting goals
Tuesday	**Semifinals: Practice Drills**	Focused skill review — math/ELA deep work
Wednesday	**Halftime Show**	Fun review games, midweek energy boost
Thursday	**Championship Round: Scrimmage**	Full STAAR-format practice under game conditions
Friday	**Pre-Game Prep: Pep Rally**	Strategies, confidence, celebration

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⏰ How to Run This Week

2 Weeks Before

- [ ] Read LESSON-PLANS.md fully
- [ ] Gather supplies (DECORATIONS.md)
- [ ] Print student materials (STUDENT-MATERIALS.md)
- [ ] Send parent letter (PARENT-LETTER.md)

Weekend Before

- [ ] Set up hallway (stadium tunnel!) and classroom (locker room!)
- [ ] Organize materials into daily packets
- [ ] Create/display tournament bracket poster

Each Morning

1. Play pump-up sports music as students enter
2. Deliver the **Coach's Huddle** (daily kickoff speech)
3. Hand out daily playbook pages
4. Run the day's drills and activities
5. Award **Daily MVP** at end of day
6. Update tournament bracket — class advances!

💡 Pro Tips

1. **Wear a whistle.** Blow it to start activities. Kids lose their minds (in a good way).
2. **Use sports language constantly.** "Let's huddle up!" "That's a championship answer!" "We need to run that drill again."
3. **The bracket is everything.** Students LOVE seeing themselves advance through a tournament.
4. **Friday pep rally should be loud.** Play music, do a class cheer, make it feel like a real pre-game.
5. **Team names matter.** Let table groups pick their team names on Monday. They'll take ownership.

Let's get that W, Coach! 🏆

🏈 STAAR Athletes: Championship Week — 5-Day Lesson Plans

> ***Head Coach's Playbook — Your game plan for the week.*** *Adapt to your grade level (3rd–8th) and tested subjects.*

Daily Schedule Template

Time Block	Duration	Activity
Coach's Huddle	10 min	Pep talk, daily game plan, motivation
Practice Drill 1	45 min	Core skill review / guided practice
Water Break	5 min	Brain break / transition
Practice Drill 2	40 min	Application / independent practice
Post-Game Wrap	10 min	Review, award MVPs, update bracket

🏈 MONDAY — Quarterfinals: Draft Day

Theme: "Every championship team starts with a draft. Today we assess our roster and build our teams."

Focus: Foundation skills assessment & team building

Coach's Huddle (10 min)

Teacher Script: > "Athletes! Welcome to Championship Week! I'm Coach [Name], and this week we're training for the biggest game of the year — STAAR. Every champion trains before game day. Michael Jordan didn't just show up and win — he practiced harder than anyone. This week, that's us. Today is Draft Day. We're building our teams, assessing our skills, and getting ready to compete. Let's go, athletes!"

Activities: - Hand out **Player Jerseys** (name tags — see STUDENT-MATERIALS.md) - Assign team names (let groups choose from options or make their own) - Reveal the **Tournament**

Bracket poster - Quick “skills combine” — 5-question diagnostic to see where students are

Practice Drill 1: Guided Review (45 min)

ELA/Reading Focus: 1. **(10 min) “Warm-Up Laps”** — 5 quick review questions on whiteboards. “Just like stretching before a game — gotta warm up those brains!” 2. **(20 min) “Film Study”** — Teacher models reading a STAAR passage like studying game film. “Watch how I break down this play…” Demonstrate annotation, evidence-finding, question analysis. 3. **(15 min) “Partner Drills”** — Pairs work through a short passage together. One reads, one annotates. Discuss answers. “A great teammate makes everyone better.”

Water Break (5 min)

- “Stretches & Sprints” — students stand, do 30 seconds of exercises (jumping jacks, arm circles, running in place), then sit. Quick physical reset.

Practice Drill 2: Independent Practice (40 min)

“Quarterfinal Playbook” Packet - STAAR-format questions covering today’s focus area - Frame: “This is your first game. Show Coach what you’ve got.” - Early finishers: “Bonus Play” challenge sheet

Differentiation: - **Struggling:** “Rookie Edition” — shorter passages, vocabulary pre-taught, guided questions - **Advanced:** “All-Star Challenge” — complex texts, analytical questions - **ELL:** Bilingual glossary, simplified question stems

Post-Game Wrap (10 min)

- Review key plays (most-missed questions)
- **Coach’s Chalkboard:** Write the day’s key strategy (like diagramming a play)
- Award **Monday MVP** — 1-2 students who showed exceptional effort
- Update bracket: “We won the quarterfinals! Moving on to semifinals!”

🏈 TUESDAY — Semifinals: Practice Drills

Theme: “Semifinals are when it gets real. Today we drill the fundamentals until they’re automatic.”

Focus: Mathematics (or your primary math-tested area)

Coach’s Huddle (10 min)

Teacher Script: > “Athletes, yesterday we won the quarterfinals. Today’s the semis — this is where pretenders get eliminated and real athletes shine. What separates good from great? PRACTICE. The fundamentals. Today we drill math until these skills are muscle memory. When you see a problem on STAAR, your brain should react automatically — like a point guard running a fast break. Let’s drill!”

Practice Drill 1 (45 min)

Math Focus (adapt to grade): 1. **(10 min) “Sprint Drill”** — Timed computation problems (2 min each set). “Quick feet, quick calculations!” 2. **(20 min) “Play Diagramming”** — Teacher models word problems step by step, drawing them out like diagramming a play on the chalkboard. Show work visually. “Here’s the play. Step 1: read the defense (the question). Step 2: identify your options. Step 3: execute.” 3. **(15 min) “Two-a-Days”** — Partners take turns being “coach” and “player.” Coach reads a problem, player solves while thinking aloud. Coach checks. Switch.

Water Break (5 min)

- “Timeout!” — Quick trivia game (non-academic sports trivia). Fun mental break.

Practice Drill 2 (40 min)

“Semifinal Playbook” Packet - 15-20 STAAR-format math problems - Include mix: computation, word problems, griddable, multi-step - “This is the semifinal. Leave it all on the field.”

Differentiation: - **Struggling:** Formula reference sheet included, worked examples at top, fewer problems - **Advanced:** “Varsity-level” problems — multi-step, real-world application - **ELL:** Simplified word problem language, key math vocabulary visuals

Post-Game Wrap (10 min)

- Review 2-3 key problems

- **Coach's Chalkboard:** Day's strategy on the board
- Award **Tuesday MVP**
- Bracket update: "Semifinals — DONE. Championship round is Thursday."

🏈 WEDNESDAY — Halftime Show 🎉

Theme: "Every great game has a halftime show. Time to catch our breath, have some fun, and refocus for the second half."

Focus: Fun review games, mixed subjects, energy boost

Coach's Huddle (10 min)

Teacher Script: > "We're at the halfway point, athletes. You've been grinding hard — two days of intense training done. Today is our Halftime Show. That doesn't mean we stop working — it means we train differently. Today is about GAMES, teamwork, and having fun while reviewing. Sometimes the best practice is play. Let's enjoy this!"

Practice Drill 1: Halftime Games (45 min)

Run 2-3 of the following (see ACTIVITIES.md for full instructions):

1. **(15 min) "STAAR Bowl"** — Jeopardy-style review game. Categories by subject/topic. Teams compete, keep score on the class "scoreboard."
2. **(15 min) "Relay Race"** — Teams line up, relay-style. Each member runs to solve one problem. First team to finish all problems correctly wins.
3. **(15 min) "Trading Card Swap"** — Students create test-strategy trading cards, then trade with classmates to collect a full set (see ACTIVITIES.md).

Water Break (5 min)

- Play pump-up music. Let students talk/socialize briefly. Real halftime vibes.

Practice Drill 2: Mixed Review (40 min)

“Halftime Report” Mixed Practice - Shorter packet than other days — 10-12 mixed-subject questions - Frame: “Quick second-half tune-up. Stay sharp.” - Remaining time: **Study Hall** — students review their weak areas using flashcards, playbooks, or past packets

Post-Game Wrap (10 min)

- **Motivational Moment:** Share a story of a sports comeback (28-3 Super Bowl, Astros 2017 WS, etc. — Texas teams get bonus points!)
- Award **Wednesday MVP**
- Bracket: “Halftime done. Second half starts tomorrow. Championship round!”
- Hand out midweek treats if desired

🏈 THURSDAY — Championship Round: Scrimmage

Theme: “This is it. The championship scrimmage. Game-like conditions. Everything you’ve trained for.”

Focus: Full STAAR-format practice test (simulated conditions)

Coach’s Huddle (10 min)

Teacher Script: > “Athletes. Today is the championship scrimmage. A scrimmage is a practice game under real conditions. I need you to treat this like the real thing. Game faces on. No talking. No distractions. Show me that you can perform when it matters. I’ve seen you train all week — I KNOW you can do this. Now prove it to yourselves.”

Practice Drill 1: Scrimmage (45 min)

Championship Scrimmage Test - Mini STAAR-format test (20-30 mixed questions) - Test conditions: silent, independent, timed - “This is the championship. Play like a champion.”

Water Break (5 min)

- Quiet stretch. Maintain intensity.

Practice Drill 2: Film Review (40 min)

Post-Scrimmage Analysis: 1. **(15 min)** Review answers as a class — “Let’s watch the game film and see what we can improve.” 2. **(10 min)** Students self-identify weak areas on an assessment sheet 3. **(15 min)** Small group “position coaching” — group students by need. Teacher and peer tutors provide targeted review.

Post-Game Wrap (10 min)

- **Coach’s Chalkboard:** Final strategies
- Award **Thursday MVP**
- Bracket: “Championship round COMPLETE. Tomorrow: PRE-GAME PREP.”
- Serious moment: “Tomorrow we celebrate. But right now, I want you to know — I’m proud of every single one of you.”

🏈 FRIDAY — Pre-Game Prep: Pep Rally 🎉

Theme: “Game day is almost here. Today we sharpen our strategies, build our confidence, and celebrate how far we’ve come.”

Focus: Test-taking strategies, confidence building, celebration

Coach’s Huddle (10 min)

Teacher Script: > “Athletes! This is it — the last day of training camp. You have worked SO hard. You ran drills. You studied film. You survived the championship scrimmage. Today is PRE-GAME PREP. We’re going to review our game plan, get our minds right, and finish with a PEP RALLY. Because when you walk into that test, you’re walking in as CHAMPIONS.”

Practice Drill 1: Strategy Session (45 min)

1. **(15 min) “Coach’s Top 10 Game-Day Plays”** — Review the 10 most important test-taking strategies (see STAAR Wars LESSON-PLANS.md Friday for the list — same strategies, sports language)
2. **(15 min) “Scouting Report”** — Analyze common STAAR “trick plays” (misleading answer choices). Students practice identifying traps.

3. **(15 min) “Captain’s Speech”** — Students write/share one thing they’ve learned and one piece of advice for their teammates. 2-3 volunteers share with the class.

Water Break (5 min)

Practice Drill 2: Pep Rally & Celebration (40 min)

1. **(10 min) “Letters to Myself”** — Students write a game-day letter, sealed in envelope for test day
2. **(10 min) “MVP Certificate Ceremony”** — Award **Championship Certificates** to every student. Call each name, handshake, photo.
3. **(10 min) “Team Cheer”** — Class creates a short STAAR cheer together. Practice it. It’s silly. It’s fun. They’ll remember it on test day.
4. **(10 min) Celebration** — Pump-up music, treats, students sign each other’s **“Championship Program”** page

Post-Game Wrap — Final Whistle (10 min)

- All 5 MVPs earned = Champion status
- Final cheer together
- “When you sit down for that STAAR test, remember: you TRAINED for this. Champions don’t hope to win — they PREPARE to win. And you’ve prepared. Now go win.”
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🎵 Daily Playlist Suggestions

Monday — Draft Day Energy

- “We Ready” — Archie Eversole
- “Remember the Name” — Fort Minor
- “All I Do Is Win” — DJ Khaled

Tuesday — Drill Intensity

- “Lose Yourself” — Eminem

- “Till I Collapse” — Eminem
- Instrumental workout beats

Wednesday — Halftime Fun

- “Uptown Funk” — Bruno Mars
- “Can’t Stop the Feeling” — Justin Timberlake
- “Happy” — Pharrell

Thursday — Game Time Focus

- “Eye of the Tiger” — Survivor
- Epic instrumental / movie score music
- Low-key focus beats

Friday — Championship Celebration

- “We Are the Champions” — Queen
- “Celebration” — Kool & The Gang
- “Don’t Stop Believin’” — Journey
- “Roar” — Katy Perry
- “Victory” — Two Steps From Hell

Leave it all on the field this week, Coach. 🏆

🏈 STAAR Athletes: Championship Week — Themed Activities

> *12 sports-themed activities for your Championship Week. Mix of drills, games, and team challenges.*

🎮 REVIEW GAMES

1. STAAR Bowl (Jeopardy-Style Game)

Type: Teams | **Time:** 25-30 min | **Best for:** Multi-subject review

Setup: - Create a 5x5 grid on the board (5 categories, 5 point values: 100-500) - Categories: Reading Plays, Math Offense, Science Defense, Vocabulary Blitz, Wild Card - Divide class into 3-4 teams

How to Play: 1. Teams take turns selecting a category and point value 2. Read the question; team has 30 seconds to discuss and answer 3. Correct = earn points. Incorrect = other teams can steal 4. "Double Points" — one hidden square doubles the points 5. Team with most points wins the STAAR Bowl

Materials: Grid on board, question cards, scoreboard

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2. Relay Race Review

Type: Teams of 5-6 | **Time:** 15-20 min | **Best for:** Quick computation, grammar, vocabulary

Setup: - Teams line up single-file facing the board - Each team has a set of questions at the front (face down)

How to Play: 1. First player runs up, flips a question, solves it, writes answer 2. Runs back, tags next teammate 3. Next player runs up, checks previous answer (fix if wrong), then solves the next question 4. First team to correctly answer all questions wins 5. Penalty: wrong answer = team must do 5 jumping jacks before continuing

Materials: Question sets (one per team), pencils, answer key

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3. March Madness Bracket Challenge

Type: Individual/class | **Time:** Ongoing all week | **Best for:** Daily engagement

Setup: - Create a tournament bracket on poster board with 16 "skills" (e.g., Main Idea, Fractions, Vocabulary, etc.) - Each day, two skills "compete" — students answer questions from both skills -

The skill the class scores higher on “advances”

How to Play: 1. Monday: 4 matchups (8 skills compete, 4 advance) 2. Tuesday: 2 matchups (4 skills, 2 advance) 3. Wednesday: Halftime — Fun bracket (favorite snacks, songs, etc.) 4. Thursday: Championship — final 2 skills compete 5. Friday: Crown the class’s “Strongest Skill”

Materials: Large bracket poster, daily question sets for each matchup

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👤 INDIVIDUAL ACTIVITIES

4. Personal Playbook (Study Guide Creation)

Type: Individual | **Time:** 20-25 min | **Best for:** Any subject synthesis

Instructions: Students create their own “playbook” — a folded booklet with their personal study notes organized as “plays”: - **Offensive Plays** = Strategies for questions they’re good at (how to maintain those skills) - **Defensive Plays** = Strategies for their weak areas (how to handle tough questions) - **Special Teams** = Test-taking tricks (elimination, time management, etc.) - **Audibles** = What to do when stuck (skip and come back, re-read, etc.)

Materials: Paper (folded into booklet), pencils, colored markers

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5. Strategy Trading Cards

Type: Individual (then partner swap) | **Time:** 20 min | **Best for:** Reviewing test-taking strategies

Instructions: Each student creates 3 trading cards (index cards): - **Front:** Strategy name + illustration (e.g., “The Eliminator” with a picture of crossing out wrong answers) - **Back:** How to use the strategy, when it works best, example - After creation, students TRADE cards with classmates to collect different strategies - Goal: collect at least 8 different strategy cards by end of week

Strategy ideas: The Eliminator, The Re-Reader, The Evidence Hunter, The Show-Your-Worker, The Time Manager, The Double Checker, The Process of Elimination Pro, The Context Clue Detective, The Key Word Finder, The Reasonableness Checker

Materials: Index cards, markers, colored pencils

6. MVP Scouting Report (Self-Assessment)

Type: Individual | **Time:** 15 min | **Best for:** Metacognition, goal setting

Instructions: Students fill out a "scouting report" on themselves: - **Player Name:** [their name] - **Position:** [their strongest subject] - **Strengths (Offensive Stats):** List 3 skills they're confident in - **Areas to Develop (Defensive Stats):** List 2-3 skills they need to work on - **Game Plan:** For each weak area, write one specific action they'll take - **Season Goal:** "On STAAR day, I will score _____ because I will _____"

Materials: Scouting Report template (printed), pencils

👥 PARTNER ACTIVITIES

7. Coach & Athlete Pairs

Type: Partner | **Time:** 20-25 min | **Best for:** Math problem solving, reading comprehension

Instructions: - Partner A = Coach (guides, questions, doesn't solve) - Partner B = Athlete (solves, thinks aloud) - Coach uses prompts: "What's the play here?", "Show me your work," "Are you sure about that call?" - Switch roles every 2-3 problems - Both partners record answers and strategies

Materials: Problem set (8-10 problems), recording sheet

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8. Two-Minute Drill (Speed Partner Quiz)

Type: Partner | **Time:** 10-15 min | **Best for:** Fact fluency, vocabulary, quick recall

Instructions: - Partners face each other with a stack of flashcards or question strips between them - Set timer for 2 minutes - Partner A quizzes Partner B as fast as possible — keep a tally of correct answers - Switch roles for another 2 minutes - Compare scores — both try to beat their own score in round 2 - "In the two-minute drill, every second counts!"

Materials: Flashcards or question strips, timer, tally sheet

👥👥 GROUP ACTIVITIES

9. Scrimmage Stations (Rotation Drill)

Type: Groups of 4-5 | **Time:** 30-35 min | **Best for:** Multi-subject review

Setup: 5 stations, each themed as a different "position": - **Quarterback Station** — Reading comprehension (leads the offense = understands the text) - **Running Back Station** — Math computation (runs the numbers) - **Wide Receiver Station** — Vocabulary (catches the meaning) - **Defensive Line Station** — Error analysis (find the mistakes) - **Kicker Station** — Word problems (precision under pressure)

How to Play: Groups rotate every 6 minutes. Complete 3-4 questions per station. Record on scorecard.

Materials: Station question sets, scorecards, timer, station labels

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10. Huddle Up: Team Problem Solving

Type: Groups of 4 | **Time:** 20 min | **Best for:** Complex multi-step problems

Instructions: 1. Each group gets ONE complex, multi-step problem (challenging!) 2. Team huddles — discuss strategy before anyone writes anything (2 min) 3. Team works together to solve (8 min) 4. One team member presents their solution to the class (2 min each) 5. Class votes: "Did they make the right call?" — discuss correct approach

Materials: One complex problem per group (laminated or on large paper), markers, chart paper for presenting

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11. Championship Bracket Debate

Type: Groups of 4 (2v2) | **Time:** 20 min | **Best for:** Reading/ELA, Social Studies

Instructions: - Present a STAAR question with 2 plausible answer choices - In each group, 2 students argue for Answer A, 2 for Answer B - Each side presents evidence (2 min per side) - Group votes, then teacher reveals correct answer - Winning side earns a point for their team on the class scoreboard

Materials: Debate questions with passages, timer, scoreboard

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12. Tailgate Party Review (End-of-Day Celebration Game)

Type: Whole class | **Time:** 20 min | **Best for:** End of Wednesday (Halftime Show)

Setup: - "Tailgate" stations around the room with snacks and games - Station 1: Vocabulary Cornhole (toss beanbags at vocab words, define the one you hit) - Station 2: Math Ring Toss (toss rings onto numbered pegs, solve the problem on that number) - Station 3: Trivia Toss (answer question correctly, earn a free throw with a paper ball into a trash can) - Station 4: Word Problem Horseshoes (solve problem, toss horseshoe — closest to the stake gets a bonus point)

Keep it simple — use what you have. Paper balls and trash cans work great. The point is FUN with learning mixed in.

Materials: Paper balls, trash cans, beanbags (or balled-up socks), vocab cards, math problems, small snacks

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📝 Activity Planning Matrix

Activity	Best Day	Duration	Type	Subject
STAAR Bowl	Wed	25-30 min	Team game	Mixed
Relay Race	Tue or Fri	15-20 min	Team game	Math/Grammar
Bracket Challenge	All week	5-10 min/day	Class	Mixed
Personal Playbook	Mon	20-25 min	Individual	Any
Trading Cards	Mon-Wed (create+trade)	20 min	Individual→Partner	Strategies
MVP Scouting Report	Mon or Thu	15 min	Individual	Metacognition

Activity	Best Day	Duration	Type	Subject
Coach & Athlete Pairs	Tue	20-25 min	Partner	Math/Reading
Two-Minute Drill	Any day (warm-up)	10-15 min	Partner	Fluency
Scrimmage Stations	Wed or Thu	30-35 min	Group rotation	Mixed
Huddle Up	Thu	20 min	Group	Complex problems
Championship Debate	Mon or Thu	20 min	Group (2v2)	ELA/SS
Tailgate Party	Wed	20 min	Whole class	Mixed (fun)

Every rep counts. Every drill matters. Train like a champion! 🏆

🏈 STAAR Athletes: Championship Week — Student Materials

> *All student-facing materials for Championship Week.*

📋 Daily Materials Overview

Day	Handouts	Rewards
Monday	Jersey Name Tag, Scouting Report, Quarterfinal Playbook	MVP Award

Day	Handouts	Rewards
Tuesday	Semifinal Playbook, Trading Card blanks	MVP Award
Wednesday	Halftime Report packet, Trading Cards (continue)	MVP Award + treats
Thursday	Championship Scrimmage Test, Self-Assessment	MVP Award
Friday	Letter to Myself, Championship Program page	MVP Award + Championship Certificate

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👕 Jersey Name Tags

Design: - Shaped like a jersey/T-shirt (or rectangular with jersey graphic) - **Front:** Student name in large text, jersey number below (use room number + seat number, e.g., “204-15”) - **Team:** [Table group team name] - **Position:** [Student’s strongest subject — they choose] - School colors as background - Tent-fold for desk display

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📖 Daily Playbook Packets

Format for each day’s packet: - **Cover:** “GAME PLAN — [Day/Round Name]” with date, student name line - **“Scouting Report” header** explaining the day’s objective in sports language - STAAR-format questions (teacher provides content) - **“Post-Game Notes”** section at the back: 3 reflection lines 1. “Strongest play today (what I did well):” 2. “Flag on the play (what tripped me up):” 3. “Game plan for tomorrow:”

🃏 Strategy Trading Cards

Description: Students create test-taking strategy cards in a trading card format. Create throughout the week, trade to collect the set.

Card format (index card): - **Front:** - Strategy name in bold (e.g., “THE ELIMINATOR”) - Illustration/icon - “Rarity” level: Common ⭐, Rare ⭐⭐, Legendary ⭐⭐⭐ - **Back:** - “How to use this play:” (2-3 sentences) - “Best used when:” (1 sentence) - “Example:” (brief example) - Created by: [student name]

10 Strategy Cards to create (assign 3 per student, trade to collect): 1. The Eliminator (cross out wrong answers) 2. The Evidence Hunter (find proof in the text) 3. The Re-Reader (read the question twice) 4. The Show-Your-Worker (write out all steps) 5. The Time Manager (pace yourself) 6. The Double Checker (review before submitting) 7. The Key Word Finder (circle important words) 8. The Context Clue Detective (figure out unknown words) 9. The Reasonableness Checker (does my answer make sense?) 10. The Skip & Return (skip hard questions, come back later)

🏅 MVP Award System

How it works: Each day, teacher selects 1-3 students as “Daily MVP” for exceptional effort, improvement, or teamwork.

MVP Award Card: - Size: 5” x 7” - Header: “⭐ DAILY MVP AWARD ⭐” - “Awarded to: [Name]” - “For: [Specific reason — e.g., ‘Outstanding effort on the Semifinal Playbook’]” - “Date: [Date]” - “Signed: Coach [Teacher Name]” - Sports graphic border

Display: Post MVP names on the class scoreboard. Students keep their award cards.

Alternative (budget): Simply announce MVPs and add a star next to their name on the scoreboard. Write names on the whiteboard in a “Hall of Fame” section.

📊 Scouting Report (Self-Assessment)

Used on: Monday (beginning of week) and/or Thursday (after scrimmage)

Design: - Title: “PLAYER SCOUTING REPORT” - **Player:** [Name] - **Team:** [Table group] - **Offensive Stats (Strengths):** - Skill 1: _____ Confidence: ★★★★★ (circle) - Skill 2: _____ Confidence: ★★★★★ - Skill 3: _____ Confidence: ★★★★★ - **Defensive Stats (Needs Work):** - Skill 1: _____ Plan to improve: _____ - Skill 2: _____ Plan

to improve: _____ - **Season Prediction:** “I will do well on STAAR because: _____” - **Coach’s Notes:** (space for teacher comments)

📐 Foam Finger Printable

Description: A fun, printable “#1” foam finger outline. Students color it, write their name, and display it on their desk or locker.

Design: - Classic foam finger shape (index finger pointing up) - Text: “#1 STAAR ATHLETE” - Space for student to write their name and team - Print on cardstock, students color with school colors - Optional: tape to a popsicle stick for “cheering” during review games

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🏆 Championship Certificate

Description: End-of-week certificate for every student. Awarded Friday.

Design: - Size: 8.5” x 11” landscape - Header: Trophy graphic + “CHAMPIONSHIP WEEK” - Title: “STAAR CHAMPION CERTIFICATE” - Body: “This certifies that **[Name]** has completed Championship Week training and is officially a STAAR Champion. This athlete demonstrated dedication, teamwork, and the heart of a champion.” - Signature: “Coach [Teacher Name]” - Date line - Border: school colors, sports graphics (footballs, trophies, stars)

📰 Championship Program Page (Friday Keepsake)

Description: Like a game-day program. Students sign each other’s copies.

Design: - Title: “CHAMPIONSHIP WEEK PROGRAM — [Year]” - **“Starting Lineup”** — space for 5-6 friend names - **“My Coach:”** [Teacher name] - **“Season Highlights:”** “My best moment this week was…” - **“My Game Day Strategy:”** one sentence - **“Autographs:”** large open space for classmates to sign - Small space: “Draw your championship trophy”

📊 Printing Summary

Material	Per Student	For 25 Students
Jersey Name Tags	0.25 pages	7 pages
Daily Playbooks (5 days)	~3-5/day	75-125 pages
Trading Card blanks	3 index cards	75 index cards
Scouting Report	1 page	25 pages
MVP Award Cards	0 (teacher prints 1-3/day)	15 cards total
Foam Finger	1 page	25 pages
Certificate	1 page	25 pages
Championship Program	1 page	25 pages
TOTAL (ex. playbooks)		**~125 pages + index cards**

Every athlete needs the right gear. These materials ARE the gear. 🏆

🏈 STAAR Athletes: Championship Week — Decoration Guide

> *Turn your hallway into a stadium tunnel and your classroom into a championship locker room.*

🕐 Setup Timeline

When	What
2 weeks before	Buy supplies, start creating banners

When	What
1 week before	Cut out pennants, prepare door signs
Friday before	Hallway setup (2 hours with help)
Monday morning	Final classroom touches (30 min)

🏟️ HALLWAY TRANSFORMATION: Stadium Tunnel

The Vision

Students walk through a "tunnel" into the stadium — just like athletes running onto the field. School colors, team banners, and a scoreboard create game-day energy.

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. Stadium Tunnel Entrance

- Hang **streamers** (school colors) from the ceiling/doorframe at the hallway entrance, creating a curtain students push through
- Alternative: cut black butcher paper into strips and hang like a curtain
- Add a banner above: **"CHAMPIONSHIP WEEK — STAAR ATHLETES ENTER HERE"**
- If allowed, play entrance music from a speaker as students walk through on Monday morning
- **Cost:** ~$3-5 for streamers

2. Locker Room Door Signs

- Each classroom door gets a "locker" treatment:
  - Teacher name as "Head Coach [Name]"
  - Subject as position: "Offensive Coordinator — Mathematics"
  - Team logo (school mascot or custom design)
- Print on colored cardstock (school colors), laminate
- Optional: tape a jersey number above each door (large printed number)

- **Cost:** ~$2-3 for cardstock

3. Hallway Scoreboard

- Create a large **scoreboard poster** in the hallway
- Title: “CHAMPIONSHIP SCOREBOARD”
- List each class period / homeroom as a “team”
- Track daily completion rates, participation, or scores
- Update daily — creates friendly competition between classes
- **Cost:** ~$2 for poster board

4. Team Pennants

- Triangle pennants hung on a string across the hallway
- Each pennant = a subject or skill: “READING,” “MATH,” “SCIENCE,” “VOCABULARY,” etc.
- Use school colors for the paper
- String them with yarn or twine
- **Cost:** ~$3-5 for cardstock + yarn

5. Floor Details

- Painter’s tape “yard lines” on the hallway floor (every few feet, label 10, 20, 30… “GOAL LINE” at classroom doors)
- Or tape down paper “footprints” (cleats!) leading to each room
- **Cost:** ~$3 for painter’s tape

Hallway Materials & Budget

Item	Quantity	Source	Est. Cost
Streamers (school colors)	4-6 rolls	Dollar Tree	$4-6
Butcher paper (for banner)	1 section	School supply	$0
Colored cardstock	15-20 sheets	Dollar Tree / school	$2-4

Item	Quantity	Source	Est. Cost
Poster board (scoreboard)	1-2	Dollar Tree	$2
Yarn/twine (for pennants)	1 roll	Dollar Tree	$1
Painter’s tape	1-2 rolls	Dollar Tree	$2-3
TOTAL			**$11-16**

🏠 CLASSROOM SETUP: Team Locker Room

The Vision

Students walk into a locker room / training facility. Team pride, motivational quotes, and a tournament bracket dominate the walls.

Door Sign

- **“TEAM [CLASS PERIOD] LOCKER ROOM — ATHLETES ONLY”**
- Print with school colors, sport graphics
- Add a jersey number (your room number!)

Desk Name Tags (Jerseys)

- **Jersey-style name tags:** shaped like a jersey or T-shirt
- Front: Student name + jersey number (their student ID # or a random assignment)
- Back: Team name (their table group)
- Print on cardstock in school colors, fold into tent tags

Wall Decorations

Tournament Bracket Poster

- Large bracket (Sweet 16 or Elite 8 format)
- Fill with skill names or subject areas

- Update daily as the class “advances” through the bracket
- THIS IS THE CENTERPIECE — make it big and visible

Coach’s Chalkboard

- Dedicate whiteboard or poster space to daily strategy
- Title: “COACH’S PLAYBOOK — TODAY’S GAME PLAN”
- Update daily with the key strategy and motivational message

Motivational Sports Quotes

Print and display: - “Hard work beats talent when talent doesn’t work hard.” - “Champions are made when nobody is watching.” — adapted - “There’s no ‘I’ in TEAM, but there IS in WIN.” - “You miss 100% of the shots you don’t take.” — Wayne Gretzky - “It’s not whether you get knocked down. It’s whether you get up.” — Vince Lombardi

Scoreboard (In-Class)

- Track team (table group) points throughout the week
- Award points for: completed work, participation, teamwork, bonus challenges
- Friday winner = “Class Champions”

Room Arrangement

- Desk clusters = team huddle formation
- Label each cluster with a team name and pennant
- Teacher desk = “Coach’s Office”

Classroom Materials

Item	Quantity	Source	Est. Cost
Door sign	1	Printed	$0
Jersey name tags	1 per student	Cardstock	$0-2
Tournament bracket poster	1 large	Poster board	$1-2

Item	Quantity	Source	Est. Cost
Motivational posters	4-6	Printed	$0
Scoreboard poster	1	Poster board	$1
Team pennants (for desks)	4-6 small	Cardstock	$0-1
TOTAL			**$2-6**

🖨️ Printable Elements Needed

Printable	Description	Size
Door Sign	“Team Locker Room — Athletes Only” with sports graphics	11x17
Locker Room Door Signs (hallway)	“Head Coach [Name] — [Subject]” for each classroom	8.5x11
Hallway Banner	“CHAMPIONSHIP WEEK — STAAR ATHLETES” in bold block letters	Banner format
Jersey Name Tags	Jersey/shirt shaped, student name + number + team	~4x5 inches
Tournament Bracket	Sweet 16 style bracket, large format	24x36
Coaching Staff Badges	For teachers: “Head Coach [Name]” with whistle graphic	3x4 (badge size)
Team Pennants	Triangle pennants with subject/skill names	~8x10 triangles
MVP Award Cards	“Today’s MVP: [Name] — For: [Reason]”	5x7
Championship Certificate	“This certifies [Name] as a STAAR Champion…”	8.5x11 landscape

Printable	Description	Size
Foam Finger Template	“#1 STAAR Athlete” foam finger outline for students to color/cut	8.5x11
Scoreboard Template	Grid for tracking team points by day	11x17
Sports Quote Posters	4-6 motivational quotes with sports graphics	8.5x11

💰 Total Budget

Area	Low	High
Hallway	$11	$16
Classroom	$2	$6
Printing	$0	$8
TOTAL	**$13**	**$30**

Dollar Store One-Stop List

- ☐ Streamers in school colors x4 ($4)
- ☐ Poster board x3 ($3)
- ☐ Cardstock pack ($1)
- ☐ Painter’s tape ($1)
- ☐ Yarn ($1)
- ☐ Star/trophy stickers ($1)
- **Total: ~$11**

Decorate like you’re hosting the Super Bowl. The energy you create sets the tone for everything. 🏆

🏈 STAAR Athletes: Championship Week — Parent Letter

> *Copy, customize, and send home. English and Spanish versions.*

English Version

[School Letterhead]

[Date]

Dear Families,

Next week is **Championship Week** in our classroom! 🏆 We're turning STAAR prep into an exciting, sports-themed training camp where your child is an athlete preparing for the "big game" — the STAAR test.

What is Championship Week? It's a themed, focused review week designed to boost your child's confidence and skills before STAAR. Each day is a "round" in a championship tournament, building toward test day. Students earn MVP awards, work through playbook-style study guides, and participate in team challenges.

When: [Monday, Date] – [Friday, Date]

What your child will experience: - 🏈 Daily "practice drills" reviewing key [Reading/Math/Science/Social Studies] skills - 🏈 A classroom transformed into a team locker room with motivational sports decor - 🏈 Team-based and individual review activities - 🏈 A championship scrimmage (practice test) on Thursday - 🏈 A Friday pep rally and certificate ceremony

How you can support your athlete at home: 1. **Good sleep** — Athletes need rest to perform! 8-10 hours each night 2. **Ask about their "game"** — "How was practice today?" "Did you earn MVP?" 3. **Review together** — Your child may bring home flashcards or a "playbook." Even 10

minutes helps 4. **Stay positive** — “You’ve been training all year. You’ve got this!” 5. **Healthy fuel** — Good breakfast and snacks keep the brain sharp

STAAR test day ([date]): - Arrive on time and well-rested - Eat a good breakfast - Remind them: “Champions prepare, and you’ve prepared. Go win!”

Thank you for supporting your child’s success. If you have questions, please reach out anytime.

Go team! 🏆

Coach [Teacher Name] [Contact info]

Versión en Español

[Membrete de la escuela]

[Fecha]

Estimadas familias,

¡La próxima semana es la **Semana del Campeonato** en nuestro salón! 🏆 Estamos convirtiendo la preparación para el STAAR en un emocionante campamento de entrenamiento deportivo donde su hijo(a) es un atleta preparándose para el “gran juego” — el examen STAAR.

¿Qué es la Semana del Campeonato? Es una semana temática de repaso diseñada para aumentar la confianza y las habilidades de su hijo(a) antes del STAAR. Cada día es una “ronda” en un torneo de campeonato. Los estudiantes ganan premios MVP, trabajan con guías de estudio estilo “libro de jugadas” y participan en desafíos de equipo.

Cuándo: [Lunes, fecha] – [Viernes, fecha]

Cómo puede apoyar a su atleta en casa: 1. **Buen descanso** — ¡Los atletas necesitan dormir! 8-10 horas cada noche 2. **Pregunte sobre su “juego”** — “¿Cómo fue la práctica hoy?” “¿Ganaste MVP?” 3. **Repasen juntos** — Su hijo(a) puede traer tarjetas de estudio a casa. Incluso 10 minutos ayudan 4. **Sea positivo(a)** — “Has entrenado todo el año. ¡Tú puedes!” 5. **Buena alimentación** — Un buen desayuno mantiene el cerebro activo

¡Vamos equipo! 🏆

Coach [Nombre del maestro(a)] [Información de contacto]

Customize all bracketed [ ] fields before sending.